

STRAWBERRY DREAM HAT

SIZES 44 TO 92



A round hat with a pink rib brim, knitted-in seeds, ear flaps with ties, and a green calyx of six sepals with an i-cord stalk on top. Five sizes, covering garment sizes 44 to 92.

Small

size 44

Medium

size 50-56

Large

size 62-68

Extra large

size 74-80

XXL

size 86-92



By Renate Dahl

Little Montessori Explorers

lmexplorers.com



Read the whole pattern before you start, and knit a gauge swatch. Mark your own size in the tables so you do not have to search as you go. **Test knit version 1.0**

BEFORE YOU START

The hat is worked in the round from the bottom up, and the whole hat is pink: rib, body and crown. The seeds are knitted into the body. When the hat is finished, the calyx is worked as a separate piece in green, six pointed sepals round an i-cord stalk, and sewn over the top. Finally the ear flaps are picked up under the rib, decreased to a point, and the tie continues straight out of the point as an i-cord.

WHAT YOU WILL LEARN

- scattering single stitches in another colour without long floats
- decreasing a round crown in eight sections
- knitting pointed leaves decreased to a single stitch
- picking up ear flaps and decreasing them to a point
- knitting i-cord for both the stalk and the ties

DIFFICULTY

Easy. The hat is the quickest piece in the collection and a good place to start. It uses the same charts as the other pieces, but over so few stitches that a mistake is put right in minutes.

SIZES AND FINISHED MEASUREMENTS

The hat is graded in five sizes, not nine like the garments. The seed chart is 8 stitches, that is 3.8 cm round, while a child head grows 1 to 3 cm between two neighbouring sizes. Nine hats would therefore have been the same five numbers under nine names. Measure the head where the hat will sit, round the forehead and over the ears, and choose by that measurement. Each garment size has exactly one hat.

Small

size 44

Medium

size 50-56

Large

size 62-68

Extra large

size 74-80

XXL

size 86-92

WHICH SIZE TO CHOOSE

Size	Fits garment size	Head circumference
Small	44	32.0 cm
Medium	50-56	35.0 to 38.0 cm
Large	62-68	41.0 to 43.0 cm
Extra large	74-80	45.0 to 46.0 cm
XXL	86-92	47.0 to 48.0 cm

FINISHED MEASUREMENTS

Size	Stitches round	Circumference	Height	Leaf length
Small	56 sts	26,7 cm	11,3 cm	2,9 cm
Medium	64 sts	30,5 cm	13,0 cm	4,3 cm
Large	72 sts	34,3 cm	15,2 cm	4,3 cm
Extra large	80 sts	38,1 cm	16,9 cm	5,7 cm
XXL	88 sts	41,9 cm	18,6 cm	5,7 cm

The circumference is deliberately smaller than the head. The rib stretches as the hat goes on and draws back in afterwards, and that is what holds it in place. A hat that measures the same as the head slides off.

YARN, TOOLS AND GAUGE

YARN AND NEEDLES

DROPS Merino Extra Fine, 50 g = approx. 105 m, in strawberry pink, leaf green and a small amount of cream white. The amounts below include a good margin, and are given per size.

Tools	For what
4 mm needles	short circular, double-pointed or Magic Loop
Darning needle	for weaving in ends and sewing on the ties
Stitch markers	eight, to mark the sections in the crown

YARN AMOUNT

Size	Pink	Green	Cream
Small	20 g	10 g	5 g
Medium	25 g	15 g	5 g
Large	30 g	20 g	5 g
Extra large	35 g	25 g	5 g
XXL	40 g	30 g	5 g

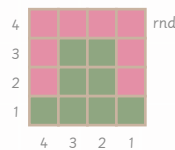
GAUGE

21 stitches and 28 rounds in stocking stitch = 10 x 10 cm on 4 mm needles. Knit your swatch in the round, not flat, and measure it after washing and drying flat. More than 21 stitches means one needle size up, fewer means one down. The gauge decides every measurement here.

STRAWBERRY TOP AND SEEDS

The rounds are worked in the order they are numbered, round 1 first, and each round is read from right to left, the same way you knit. The strawberry top is 4 stitches and is repeated round. It is deliberately smaller than the leaf on the larger garments: on a mitten or a sock the large leaf would cover almost the whole surface.

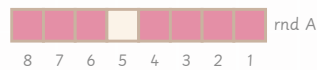
STRAWBERRY TOP, 4 STITCHES x 4 ROUNDS



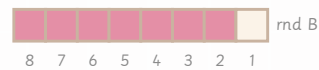
● leaf green ● strawberry pink ● cream white, one seed

SEED, 8 STITCHES

A



B



The seeds are single cream white stitches. On such a small area two seed rounds are enough: work round A, then 2-3 rounds in pink, then round B. The two rounds offset the seeds against each other.

The float behind the work is never longer than 3 stitches in either chart. That is deliberate: long loose strands on the inside are both uncomfortable against the skin and something small fingers can catch in. Keep the carried yarn loose enough that the work does not pucker.

1 • THE RIB

Cast on in pink, join in the round without twisting the cast-on, and place a marker at the beginning of the round. Work twisted rib, that is *k1 through the back loop, p1*, until the rib measures the height in your column. The rib is pink, not green, and it is not folded: it stands as a narrow band at the lower edge.

Size	Cast on	Rib
Small	56 sts	2,0 cm
Medium	64 sts	2,0 cm
Large	72 sts	2,5 cm
Extra large	80 sts	2,5 cm
XXL	88 sts	3,0 cm

THE CAST-ON

Cast on loosely. The hat has to go over the head, and the rib is the only thing holding it back. A tight cast-on is the most common reason a baby hat will not go on, and it shows most in the smallest sizes.

2 · THE PINK SECTION AND SEEDS

Continue in pink stocking stitch in the round, that is knit on every round. On a seed round work seed round A from page 5, that is *3 pink, 1 cream, 4 pink*, repeated round. Work 3 rounds in pink. Then work seed round B, that is *7 pink, 1 cream*, repeated round. The two rounds offset the seeds against each other, so they look scattered rather than lined up.

Size	Stitches	Pink section	Seed repeats round
Small	56 sts	5,0 cm	7 x
Medium	64 sts	6,0 cm	8 x
Large	72 sts	7,0 cm	9 x
Extra large	80 sts	8,0 cm	10 x
XXL	88 sts	8,5 cm	11 x

Measure the pink section from where the rib ends, not from the cast-on. The rib stands as it is, and counts separately in the height table.

3 • SHAPING THE CROWN

All of this is worked in PINK. Divide the round into 8 equal sections and place a marker at each. The stitch count in every size is divisible by 8, so the sections come out even without adjustment. Then work as follows: a decrease round where you knit 2 together just before each marker, that is 8 stitches decreased, then 1 round in knit. Repeat until 8 stitches remain. The number of decrease rounds is in your column. Cut the yarn, draw it through the 8 stitches, tighten and fasten off on the inside.

Size	Start	Decrease rounds	Left after decreasing	Height of the crown
Small	56 sts	6 x	8 sts	4,3 cm
Medium	64 sts	7 x	8 sts	5,0 cm
Large	72 sts	8 x	8 sts	5,7 cm
Extra large	80 sts	9 x	8 sts	6,4 cm
XXL	88 sts	10 x	8 sts	7,1 cm

Always decrease in the same place relative to the marker. The decreases then form eight clear lines up towards the top, and it is that line that makes a round hat look round rather than lopsided.

4 • THE CALYX AND ITS SEPALS

The calyx is a separate piece in green, worked from the top down: first the stalk, then the sepals. It is sewn over the top of the hat at the end.

- Cast on 3 stitches in green and work an i-cord until the stalk measures the length in your column.
- Increase evenly on the next round to the stitch count in your column, and divide the stitches into 6 equal sections. Each section is one sepal.
- Work each sepal separately, back and forth in stocking stitch: work 3 rows straight, then decrease 1 stitch at each side on every 4th row until 1 stitch remains. Draw the yarn through and fasten off.
- Repeat until all 6 sepals are done.

Size	Stalk stitches	Stalk	Increase to	Leaves	Sts per leaf	Decrease rows	Leaf length
Small	3 sts	4 cm	30 sts	6 x	5 sts	2 x	2,9 cm
Medium	3 sts	4 cm	42 sts	6 x	7 sts	3 x	4,3 cm
Large	3 sts	5 cm	42 sts	6 x	7 sts	3 x	4,3 cm
Extra large	3 sts	5 cm	54 sts	6 x	9 sts	4 x	5,7 cm
XXL	3 sts	6 cm	54 sts	6 x	9 sts	4 x	5,7 cm

Sew the calyx down with small stitches along the base of the sepals, not along the points. That lets the sepals lie loosely out over the pink, the way they do on a strawberry, instead of being sewn down flat.

5 • THE EAR FLAPS AND THE TIES

The flaps are picked up in the cast-on edge, under the rib, one on each side. Find centre front and centre back, and place the flaps midway between them, that is right under where the ear sits. Pick up in pink the number of stitches your column says.

- Work 4 rows in stocking stitch back and forth.
- Then decrease 1 stitch at each side every other row, until 3 stitches remain.
- Work an i-cord on those 3 stitches until the tie measures the length in your column, and cast off. The tie therefore grows straight out of the point of the flap, it is not sewn on.
- Work the second flap exactly the same.

Size	Pick up per flap	Straight rows	Decrease rows	Height of the flap	Tie
Small	11 sts	4	4 x	4,3 cm	22 cm
Medium	13 sts	4	5 x	5,0 cm	25 cm
Large	13 sts	4	5 x	5,0 cm	28 cm
Extra large	15 sts	4	6 x	5,7 cm	30 cm
XXL	15 sts	4	6 x	5,7 cm	32 cm

The ties are tied in a bow under the chin, never in a knot. Count the rows rather than measuring on the second flap, so the two come out the same length.

FOR YOU, THE TEST KNITTER

This edition of the the hat is a test knit version. Every stitch count has been calculated from the babies' measurements and the gauge, and checked against the others, but nobody has knitted from the pattern yet. You are the first. That means you may run into things I have not seen, and that is exactly why I need you.

WHAT I NEED FROM YOU

- Which size you knitted, and which yarn and needles you used.
- Your own gauge, measured on a washed swatch dried flat.
- The finished measurements of the garment after washing, in the form below.
- Anything unclear: a sentence you had to read three times, a stitch count that did not add up, a place where you had to guess.
- A photo of the finished garment, on the baby if you like.
- Tell me if the pattern reminds you of one you have seen before. Strawberry Dream is drawn for LME, and I want to know straight away if something still sits too close to something else.

MEASUREMENT FORM, FILL IN AFTER WASHING

Size knitted

My gauge, stitches per 10 cm

My gauge, rounds per 10 cm

Yarn and needles

Chest after washing

Total length after washing

Time taken, roughly

Yarn used, grams

HOW TO SEND IT IN

Send the form, your comments and any photos to <https://lmexplorers.com/teststrikk>. The deadline is given in the email the pattern came in.

Nothing is too small to mention. Whatever tripped you up will trip up the next knitter too, and it is far easier to fix now than later.

FINISHING AND AFTERCARE

CHECKLIST

- Weave in all ends flat and firmly on the wrong side. Do not cut them flush.
- Soak the work in lukewarm water with wool detergent. Do not rub or wring.
- Press the water out in a towel and dry the garment flat to the given measurements.
- Check all buttons, ties, edges and loose ends before the garment is worn.
- Ties must always be tied in a bow that comes undone if the child pulls at it, and the hat should be taken off when the child sleeps.
- Measure the garment after washing and write the numbers in the form on the previous page.

SAFETY

Buttons and ties on children's garments must always be checked before use, and the garment worn only under supervision. Sew buttons on with strong thread and go over them again after every wash. In the smallest sizes the garment sits right against the skin, so feel that no seam or knot presses hard.

Happy knitting!

STRAWBERRY DREAM

THE WHOLE COLLECTION

- Strawberry Dream dress, sleeveless with a leaf yoke and a flared skirt.
- Strawberry Dream romper with skirt, with a nappy panel and buttons at the crotch.
- Strawberry Dream jumper and skirt, a two-piece set with an elasticated waist.
- Strawberry Dream mittens, thumbless, with a connecting cord, sizes 44 to 74.
- Strawberry Dream booties, with a folded rib cuff and ties at the ankle, sizes 44 to 92.
- Strawberry Dream hat, with a ring of strawberry tops and a stalk on top, sizes 44 to 92.
- Strawberry Dream socks, with a heel flap and a grafted wedge toe, sizes 44 to 92.

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